

SAHIBA CHOPRA

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Research interests: Strategy; AI and the future of work; entrepreneurship

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

PhD in Management Science

Expected 2027

University of California, Berkeley

Master of Science in Business Administration

University of San Francisco

Master of Science in Applied Economics

University of Maryland, College Park

Bachelor of Arts in Economics and Mandarin Chinese (double major)

Huayu Enrichment Scholarship, Ministry of Education, Taiwan; Economics Department Service Award

JOB MARKET PAPER

Not Worth the Effort: Generative AI and Effort Opacity in Collaborative Work

Solo-authored

Generative AI helps individuals produce more, and sometimes better work, yet much work is inherently collaborative and relies on a reciprocal exchange of effort between creators and reviewers. While it is often assumed that work itself signals effort, I argue that AI creates *effort opacity* — a fundamental informational shift that decouples work from the effort that created it. Using a custom AI classifier on data from top GitHub projects with over 1 million stars and 2 million downstream dependencies, I document a reciprocity penalty for AI code. Despite controlling for code quality, AI code receives 25% less detailed feedback, 22% more general feedback, and a significantly higher rate of outright rejection. A pre-registered study with software developers isolates the underlying mechanism, recasting the widely documented “anti-AI bias” as an information problem rather than an inherent aversion to AI. In the study, I hold code quality constant and manipulate AI and effort cues. I find that the discount in reciprocity for AI work is driven by low effort legibility and not perceived quality, general AI aversion, or judgments about the creator. These findings reveal a critical paradox - while AI accelerates individual productivity, it simultaneously degrades the informational architecture required to attract the complementary review necessary for the development and integration of work.

RESEARCH UNDER REVIEW

Which Ideas Attract Workers? Gender and Labor Supply in Startups

Solène Delecourt (UC Berkeley Haas), Katelyn Cranney (Stanford), **Sahiba Chopra**, and Rembrand Koning (Harvard Business School)

Revise and resubmit, Management Science

Best Conference Paper Award nominee and Research Methods Paper Prize nominee, Strategic Management Society Annual Conference (2023)

Combining data on more than 52,000 U.S. high-potential startups and 2.5 million worker histories with a preregistered, incentive-compatible field experiment, we find that male job seekers are 6.8 percentage points less likely to apply to female-focused startups. The findings identify who benefits from a venture’s idea as a nonpecuniary job attribute that can constrain talent acquisition and venture growth.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Chopra, S., & Wydick, B. (2024). The health costs of political identity: Evidence from the U.S. during the COVID-19 pandemic. *Politics, Groups, and Identities*, 12(5), 1093–1117.

Van Nuenen, T., Sachdeva, P. S., & **Chopra, S.** (forthcoming). The fabricated front: Generative AI and the opacity of workplace performance. *The Paris Journal on AI & Digital Ethics*.

WORKING PAPERS AND PROJECTS

The Technical Debt Tradeoff: Generative AI, Shipping Speed, and the Future Cost of Work

Sahiba Chopra and Dhruv Agarwal (Middleware HQ)

Using de-identified software-delivery data from a B2B SaaS partner, we study whether generative AI changes the tradeoff between faster shipping and the accumulation of technical debt. The project treats technical debt as an organizational outcome that shapes maintenance, coordination, reliability, and long-term capacity.

From AI Tools to AI Systems: How Organizations Redesign Work Around Generative AI

Sahiba Chopra, Calista Cooper (Vendasta), Kim Coutts (Vendasta), and Mathijs de Vaan (UC Berkeley)

In collaboration with a technology company undergoing an AI-first transformation, we study how firms move from individual experimentation to governed, AI-enabled workflows. We examine how knowledge infrastructure, roles, and governance change when employees increasingly design and oversee AI agents and systems.

Whose Transparency Is It Anyway?

Genevieve Smith (BAIR, UC Berkeley), **Sahiba Chopra**, Natalia Luka (UC Berkeley), and Min Kyung Lee (UT Austin)

Using a survey of 400 end users, AI builders, and policymakers together with participatory design sessions, we examine whose transparency needs are reflected in current generative AI governance. We find that existing tools serve builders more effectively than end users, motivating participatory and stakeholder-specific transparency infrastructures.

AWARDS AND GRANTS

Institute for Business Innovation Research Grant, UC Berkeley (\$2,600)	2026
Institute for Business Innovation Research Grant, UC Berkeley (\$5,000)	2024
Department Grant for Dissertation Work, UC Berkeley (\$3,000)	2024
Best Conference Paper Award nominee, Strategic Management Society Annual Conference	2023
Research Methods Paper Prize nominee, Strategic Management Society Annual Conference	2023
Center for Equity, Gender & Leadership Research Grant, UC Berkeley (\$5,000)	2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching interests: Technology and innovation strategy; organizational behavior; AI and the future of work; research methods

UC Berkeley Haas School of Business 2023–2025
Graduate Student Instructor, MBA “Leading People” Berkeley, CA

· Supported instruction for Mathijs de Vaan’s MBA course; designed course infrastructure, graded assignments and exams, held office hours, and advised students on course and career questions.

UC Berkeley D-Lab 2024–2025
Data Science & AI Fellow Berkeley, CA

- Taught workshops on Python Fundamentals, R Data Visualization, and Git Fundamentals to graduate students and researchers across disciplines.

Packt Publishing

2019

Instructor

Online

- Developed and taught online courses on machine-learning methods, including “Hands-On Feature Engineering in Python” and “Scikit-Learn Recipes.”

PROFESSIONAL AND UNIVERSITY SERVICE

Academy of Management Annual Meeting

- Co-organizer, “Beyond Productivity: Designing Research on AI Adoption, Evaluation, and Training” Professional Development Workshop 2026
- Ad hoc reviewer 2026
- Organizer, panel symposium on generative AI and organizations 2025

UC Berkeley Haas School of Business

- Organizer, PhD Community Social Programming 2024–2025
- Organizer, PhD Admissions Visit Weekend 2023

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS AND CONFERENCE ACTIVITIES

- University of San Francisco, Department of Economics — upcoming presentation September 2026
- Academy of Management Annual Meeting — PDW organizer and presenter July 2026
- Wharton AI and the Future of Work Conference — presenter (poster session) May 2026
- Bay Area Behavioral and Experimental Economics Conference — presenter May 2026
- AI Plus Management Doctoral Consortium — presenter May 2026
- Bay Area Management PhD Conference — presenter April 2026
- University of California Open Summit — panelist April 2026
- All Tech Is Human x Mastercard AI Governance Workshop — presenter April 2026
- Academy of Management Annual Meeting — panel symposium organizer August 2025
- Duke Strategy Conference — presenter May 2025
- NABE TEC Conference — presenter (poster session) November 2020

SELECTED INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Happy Loans

2018–2019

Lead Data Scientist

Mumbai, India

- First data-science hire; built credit-risk models supporting US\$2 million in lending, reducing the loan-default rate by 2% while increasing the approval rate by 10%.
- Integrated alternative data sources and built portfolio-health dashboards for business teams.

SugarBox

2017–2018

Data Scientist

Mumbai, India

- Built infrastructure to store and analyze 20 TB of daily usage logs from 200 edge servers and developed a recommendation engine for 20,000 users that increased time spent in the mobile app by 80%.

Mahindra Susten

2015–2017

Data Scientist

Mumbai, India

- Developed solar-inverter fault-detection models that generated US\$1 million in operations-and-maintenance savings.

- Built wind-power forecasting models with more than 95% accuracy, leading to a US\$500,000 analytics-services contract.

METHODS AND TOOLS

Field and online experiments; causal inference; machine learning; computational text analysis; Python; R; Stata; Git

REFERENCES

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dm@berkeley.edu

Professor and Lorraine Tyson Mitchell Chair in Leadership and Communication, UC Berkeley Haas School of Business